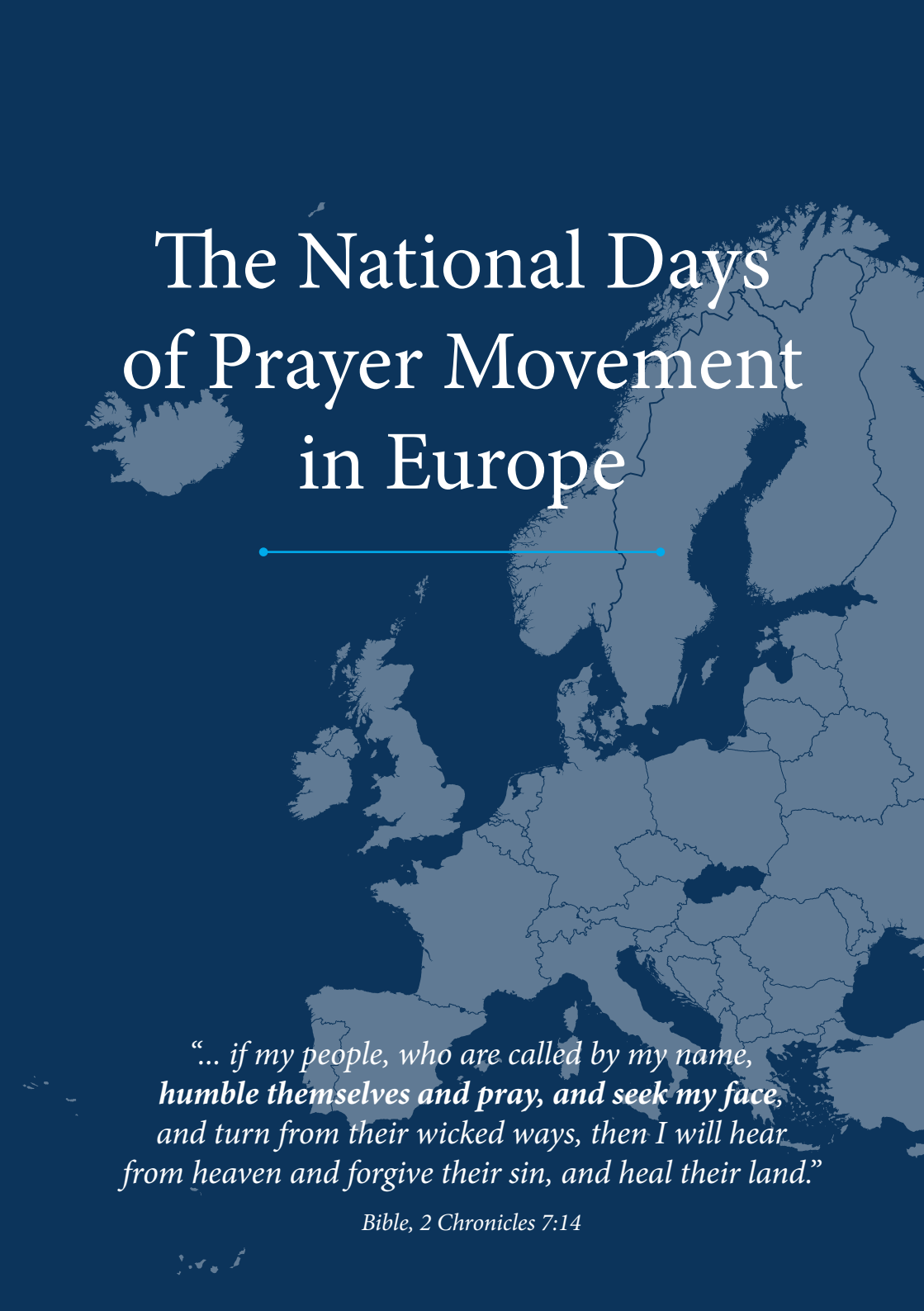




The National Days of Prayer Movement in Europe

*“... if my people, who are called by my name,
humble themselves and pray, and seek my face,
and turn from their wicked ways, then I will hear
from heaven and forgive their sin, and heal their land.”*

Bible, 2 Chronicles 7:14

Throughout history, from the Middle Ages to the present day

The mission of the National Days of Prayer Movement in Europe is to encourage the establishment of a National Day of Prayer at the state level in every European country, fostering unity among the peoples of Europe through common prayer for their nations, freedom, the common good, peace, and a prosperous future for the European continent.

Throughout history, from the Middle Ages to the present day

Throughout history, from the Middle Ages to the present day, spiritual and national leaders across Europe have called their peoples to **unite in prayer during critical moments of challenge and decision.**

These initiatives have strengthened social cohesion, inspired hope and faith, and, in certain instances, played a significant role in events that shaped the destiny of nations and influenced the course of European history.



The Victory at Lepanto (1571)

Before the decisive battle between the Christian coalition and the Ottoman Empire, **Pope Pius V** called **all of Europe to prayer**.

The victory at Lepanto halted the Ottoman advance into Europe and was widely perceived as an answer to the united prayers of Christians across the continent.



England's National Prayer During the Spanish Armada Crisis (1588)

Queen Elizabeth I called the people of England to prayer and fasting before the invasion of the Spanish Armada.

The defeat of the Armada, aided by severe storms, changed the balance of power in Europe and marked the rise of England as a leading naval power.



Days of thanksgiving and prayer subsequently became a national tradition.

The Prayer Movement of the Moravian Brethren *(18th–19th Centuries)*

A continuous prayer movement began in 1727 at the estate of Count Zinzendorf in Herrnhut, Germany.

The prayer watch continued uninterrupted for more than a century and became a catalyst for spiritual renewal. This movement laid the foundation for modern Protestant missions, sending thousands of missionaries across the globe and profoundly influencing Christianity worldwide.



United Kingdom — a story of victory

Four days after taking office as prime minister in May 1940, Winston Churchill declared a national day of prayer. People across Britain flocked to local churches and chapels, concerned by news of the German advance on the British Expeditionary Force (BEF) in Belgium and France. Five days later, news reached the country of the successful evacuation of British troops from Dunkirk.

“You ask me what our policy is? I say: to wage war by sea, by land, and by air, with all the might and power that God gives us; to wage war against a terrible tyranny, which surpasses all human crimes.”

*Prime Minister
of Great Britain 1940-45
Winston Churchill*



The European Union

The European Union was born not only at the negotiating table, but also through the shared prayers of Christian leaders who sought God's wisdom for the reconciliation of the peoples of Europe.



After the devastation of World War II, Europe lay in ruins. France and Germany, nations that had been adversaries for centuries, were searching for a path toward reconciliation.

Two Christian statesmen — Robert Schuman of France and Konrad Adenauer of Germany — were deeply committed believers.

Before key meetings and important decisions, they often prayed together, convinced that Europe's future should be built not only on political and economic interests, but also on the Christian values of reconciliation, forgiveness, and human dignity. Their vision helped lay the foundations for a new Europe based on cooperation, peace, and mutual respect among nations.

The Leipzig Peace Prayer Movement *(1982–1989)*

The weekly Prayer Meetings for Peace and Freedom held at St. Nicholas Church (Nikolaikirche) in Leipzig, East Germany, became one of the defining spiritual forces behind the Peaceful Revolution of 1989.

What began as a small prayer gathering grew into a nationwide movement that inspired peaceful civic action and helped bring about the fall of the Berlin Wall, the reunification of Germany, and the restoration of freedom across Central and Eastern Europe after decades of communist oppression.



The Singing Revolution in Latvia, Estonia, and Lithuania (1987–1991)

The peaceful movement for independence was marked by mass gatherings where **people sang in their native Baltic languages and prayed for freedom.**

The movement united the peoples of the Baltic States, helping to restore their independence and inspiring a revival of faith, spiritual life, and national identity.



Prayer and Christian Resistance in the Fall of Romania's Communist Regime

The Romanian Revolution of 1989 began in Timișoara, where Pastor László Tőkés became a symbol of resistance.

Churches became places of prayer and peaceful protest, while faith inspired the moral awakening of society.

After decades of communist atheism, Romania witnessed a significant spiritual revival alongside its return to freedom.



The Collapse of the Soviet Union *(1991)*

Millions of Christians around the world prayed fervently for the fall of the Iron Curtain, the end of the Cold War, and the liberation of nations from totalitarian rule.

The historic events that followed led to the collapse of the communist system, the dissolution of the Soviet Union, and the restoration of freedom for peoples who had longed for independence and the right to determine their own future for decades.



The European Prayer Breakfast

In 1998, a remarkable initiative was launched in Brussels, **bringing together European leaders in prayer for peace, freedom, and the future of Europe.**

The European Prayer Breakfast stands as a powerful reminder that the strength of Europe lies not only in political cooperation and economic prosperity, but also in shared values, human dignity, spiritual wisdom, and responsible leadership.



National spiritual event in Poland

On November 19, 2016, a solemn liturgy was held at the Shrine of Divine Mercy in Krakow, during which Polish Catholic bishops **proclaimed Jesus Christ “King and Lord”** and symbolically recognized Him as King of Poland.

The ceremony was attended by Polish President Andrzej Duda and then-Prime Minister Beata Szydło, as well as tens of thousands of believers.

The bishops and the believers present prayed together: **“Jesus Christ, reign over us!”**

This important spiritual event influenced the development of society, culture, and even the economy.



Russia's Full-Scale Invasion of Ukraine (2022)

When many experts predicted that Ukraine would quickly fall, **millions of people across Ukraine and around the world united in prayer for its protection and survival.**

Against all expectations, Ukraine endured and continues to defend its freedom and sovereignty. For many people of faith, the resilience of the Ukrainian nation stands as a powerful testimony to God's guidance, protection, and faithfulness during one of the greatest challenges in its history.



These stories represent only a small part of Europe's rich spiritual heritage. **Every nation can recall moments when, in times of uncertainty and challenge, people united in prayer, found renewed hope and courage, and witnessed events that shaped the destiny of their society and nation.**

The history of Europe reminds us that prayer has often been a powerful force for unity, renewal, and hope for future generations.



National Days of Prayer in the United States

July 20, 1775 – The Continental Congress issued a proclamation recommending observance of “a day of public repentance before God, fasting, and prayer.”

In 1795, George Washington proclaimed a day of public thanksgiving and prayer.

May 9, 1798 – John Adams proclaimed this day a “day of solemn repentance, fasting, and prayer.”

March 3, 1863 – Abraham Lincoln signed a congressional resolution during the Civil War that called for a day of fasting and prayer on April 30, 1863.

President Harry S. Truman proclaimed a National Day of Prayer, celebrated since **July 4, 1952**.

The story behind the signing of Public Law 100-307 on the National Day of Prayer in the United States (May 5, 1988)

US President Ronald Reagan designated the first Thursday of May as **National Day of Prayer**. On this day, US citizens can turn to God in prayer and reflection in churches, groups, and individually.



102 STAT. 456

PUBLIC LAW 100-307—MAY 5, 1988

Public Law 100-307
100th Congress

An Act

May 5, 1988
[S. 1378]

To provide for setting aside the first Thursday in May as the date on which the National Day of Prayer is celebrated.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the United States of America in Congress assembled, That the joint resolution entitled "Joint Resolution to provide for setting aside an appropriate day as a National Day of Prayer", approved April 17, 1952 (Public Law 82-324; 66 Stat. 64), is amended by striking "a suitable day each year, other than a Sunday," and inserting in lieu thereof "the first Thursday in May in each year".

36 USC 169b.

Approved May 5, 1988.



National Days of Prayer in the Ukraine



ПОСТАНОВА Верховної Ради України

Про встановлення Національного дня молитви

3 метою сприяння зміцненню національної єдності та консолідації українського суспільства, піднесення морально-шарлотичного духу,

спираючись на тисячолітню історію та культуру Українського народу та його державності з християнським світоглядом,

усвідомлюючи відповідальність перси Богом, попередніми, нинішнім та прийдешніми поколіннями,

надаючи шпуну всім, хто посилає своє життя, захищаючи свободу і незалежність України впродовж століть, а на сучасному етапі - від збройної агресії російської федерації,

висловлюючи шпуну владчості захисникам та захисницям, які ціною власного життя і здоров'я мужньо захищають мир, свободу, споконвічні цінності Українського народу та привносять перемогу України,

підносячи до Бога молитву пошуку за те, що в день початку відомої війни російської федерації проти України дав нам силу та можливість захистити суверенітет та незалежність нашої держави, зберегти існування Українського народу,

наголошуючи на необхідності посилення зусиль з метою якнайшвидшого завершення повномасштабної збройної агресії російської федерації, встановлення сталого справедливого миру, беззастережного відновлення територіальної цілісності України,

спираючись на історичний досвід інших держав і народів,

Верховна Рада України **постановляє:**

1. Установити в Україні Національний день молитви, який відзначати щорічно 24 лютого.
2. Верховній Раді України у Національний день молитви забезпечувати проведення заходів Верховної Ради України, яке повинати вшанування духовного гмму України "Боже великий, єдиний".
3. Кабінету Міністрів України у тримісячний строк з дня прийняття цієї Постанови розробити із залученням представників Весукраїнської Ради Церков і релігійних організацій та затвердити комплексний план заходів щодо відзначення на державному рівні Національного дня молитви.
4. Обласним, Київській та Севастопольській міським державним адміністраціям забезпечувати підготовку та здійснення комплексу заходів щодо відзначення Національного дня молитви.
5. Ця Постанова набирає чинності з дня її прийняття.

Голова Верховної Ради
України

Р. СТЕФАНЧУК

м. Київ
12 лютого 2025 року
№ 4243-IX

Ukraine is the only
country in Europe
where,
on February 12, 2025,
a law was passed
that provides for

February 24
The National Day
of Prayer

Joint Prayer by European Leaders in Kyiv

On February 24, 2026, on National Day of Prayer, an interfaith prayer service was held at St. Sophia Cathedral in Kyiv, attended by President Volodymyr Zelenskyy and his wife Olena, as well as high ranking guests, including European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen, President of the European Council António Costa, President of Finland Alexander Stubb, Prime Minister of Denmark Mette Frederiksen, Prime Minister of Estonia Kristen Michal, Prime Minister of Iceland Kristrún Frostadóttir, Latvian Prime Minister Evika Silina, Norwegian Prime Minister Jonas Gahr Støre, Croatian Prime Minister Andrej Plenković,



Joint Prayer by European Leaders in Kyiv



Swedish Prime Minister Ulf Kristersson, and Lithuanian Minister of National Defense Robertas Kaunas. The prayer was led by bishops and leaders of churches and religious organizations.

In his address, the Head of State noted: **“Today, within the walls of St. Sophia Cathedral in Kyiv, a united prayer for Ukraine was offered. For blessings and assistance for Ukrainian soldiers, for the release of prisoners of war, for every man and woman who was forced to leave their home, for all Ukrainians, and for unity and peace for the Ukrainian people.”**

National Day of Prayer unites millions of people

Today, as Europe once again confronts war brought about by Russian aggression and faces increasing threats to freedom, security, and peace, the need for God's help has never been greater.

A National Day of Prayer offers an opportunity for millions of people to unite in seeking God's guidance, praying for peace, wisdom for leaders, protection for their nations, and blessings for future generations.

In times of uncertainty, prayer can become a powerful expression of hope, unity, and faith in a peaceful and secure future for Europe.



**The Lord gave
King Solomon
wise advice
for difficult
times...**

*"...if my people, who are called
by my name, humble themselves
and pray, and seek my face,
and turn from their wicked ways,
then I will hear from heaven
and forgive their sin, and heal
their land."*

Bible, 2 Chronicles 7:14

Benefits

of Establishing a National Day of Prayer at the State Level

For Society

- Strengthening national unity and social solidarity.
- Fostering a culture of mutual respect, trust, and responsibility.
- Promoting moral and spiritual values.
- Inspiring hope and resilience during times of crisis and challenge.
- Encouraging charity, compassion, and service to others.

For the State

- Uniting citizens around a shared vision for the nation's future.
- Strengthening national identity and social stability.
- Promoting a culture of responsible citizenship.
- Supporting peace, social cohesion, and national security.
- Demonstrating respect for spiritual heritage and freedom of religion.

For Churches and Religious Communities

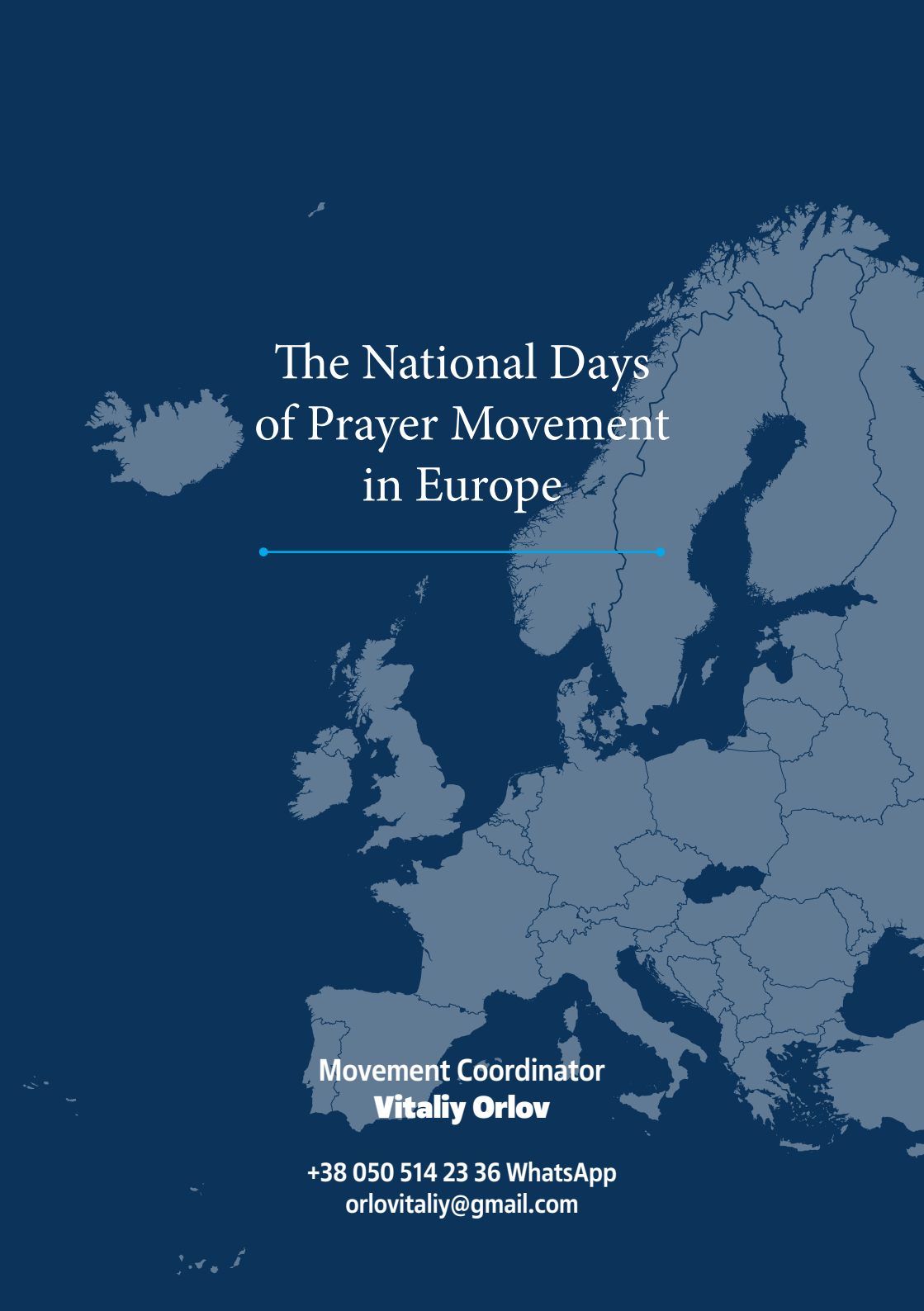
- Advancing interfaith and interdenominational dialogue and cooperation.
- Uniting believers in prayer for their nation and its people.
- Strengthening the role of churches in serving society and local communities.
- Creating a common platform for spiritual unity.
- Affirming the importance of faith, hope, and moral values in public life.

Practical Steps

For Establishing a National Day of Prayer at the State Level

1. Unite Churches and Religious Communities Around the Initiative
2. Form an Interdenominational Steering Committee
3. Develop the Vision and Supporting Framework
4. Engage Government and National Leaders
5. Prepare a Legislative Proposal
6. Secure Official Recognition of the National Day of Prayer
7. Celebrate the First National Day of Prayer





The National Days of Prayer Movement in Europe

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